

Quantum Fault Tolerance Meets Toom's Contours

Michael Ben-Or David Ponnarovsky

May 21, 2026

1 Hadamard and S Gates

Claim 1.1. For any generator subset S' of size d' , denote by $x_{S'}$ and $z_{S'}$ the following assignments:

$$x_{S'} := \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'} \quad z_{S'} := \sum_{u \in \langle S/S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'}$$

Then $x_{S'}$ and $z_{S'}$ are binary representations of anticommuting logical codewords of the (d, d') -Toric code. In particular, $x_{S'} \in \mathcal{C}_X / \mathcal{C}_Z^\perp$, $z_{S'} \in \mathcal{C}_Z / \mathcal{C}_X^\perp$, and $x_{S'} z_{S'} = 1$. In addition, let $X_{S'}$ and $Z_{S'}$ be the Pauli matrices obtained by multiplying each non-trivial coordinate of them by X or Z , respectively.

Proof. By definition $x_{S'}$ and $z_{S'}$ are binary assignments on the d' -dimensional faces. We start by showing that $x_{S'} \in \mathcal{C}_X$ and $z_{S'} \in \mathcal{C}_Z$:

$$\begin{aligned} \partial^- \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'} &= \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \sum_{g \in S'} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'/g} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}\mathbf{u}, S'/g} \\ &= \sum_{g \in S'} \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'/g} + \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{g}\mathbf{u}, S'/g} \\ &= \sum_{g \in S'} \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'/g} + \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'/g} = 0 \\ \partial^+ \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S/S'} &= \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \sum_{g \in S'} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S/S' \cup g} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}^{-1}\mathbf{u}, S/S' \cup g} \\ &= \sum_{g \in S'} \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S/S' \cup g} + \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{g}^{-1}\mathbf{u}, S/S' \cup g} \\ &= \sum_{g \in S'} \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S/S' \cup g} + \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S/S' \cup g} = 0 \end{aligned}$$

Thus $x_{S'} \in \mathcal{C}_X$ and $z_{S'} \in \mathcal{C}_Z$, now for showing that they are not binary representations of stabilizers, it's enough to show they admit no vanishing product.

$$x_{S'} z_{S'} = \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'} \sum_{u \in \langle S/S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'} = \theta_{\mathbf{e}, S'} \theta_{\mathbf{e}, S'} = 1$$

□

Definition 1.2 (The Transpose Map). Let d, d' be integers, and let $\mathcal{G}$ be a (d, d') -Toric complex generated by the generator set S . We define the *transpose map* $\phi : \mathcal{F}^{d'} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{d-d'}$ by acting on the basis elements as follows:

$$\phi(\theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'}) \rightarrow \theta_{\mathbf{v}^{-1}, \mathbf{S}/\mathbf{S}'}$$

Notice that for $d' = d - d'$, the transpose map is a permutation over the bits.

Definition 1.3 (Hadamard-Type Gate H_ϕ). For $d' = d - d'$, we define the logical Hadamard-type gate $H_\phi : L \rightarrow L$ as follows, for any $S' \subset S$, of size d' :

$$\begin{aligned} H_\phi(X_{S'}) &\rightarrow Z_{S/S'} \\ H_\phi(Z_{S'}) &\rightarrow X_{S/S'} \end{aligned}$$

Claim 1.4. The Hadamard-type gate H_ϕ has a fold-transversal implementation by, first applying H^n over all the physical qubits, and then permuting them by the transpose map ϕ , namely $\hat{H}_\phi = \phi \circ H^n$.

Proof. Clearly, for any subset of generators $S' \subset S$, the map ϕ sends $x_{S'}$ to $z_{S/S'}$:

$$\phi(x_{S'}) = \phi\left(\sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{S}'}\right) = \sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, \mathbf{S}/\mathbf{S}'} = z_{S/S'}$$

Moreover, ϕ sends binary representations of Z -stabilizers to binary representations of X -stabilizers, and vice versa. To see this, consider a $d' + 1$ dimensional face, and consider the image of the stabilizer it defines.

$$\begin{aligned} \phi(\partial^- \theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'}) &= \phi\left(\sum_{g \in S'} \theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'/\mathbf{g}} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'/\mathbf{g}}\right) \\ &= \sum_{g \in S'} \theta_{\mathbf{v}^{-1}, (\mathbf{S}/\mathbf{S}') \cup \mathbf{g}} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}^{-1}\mathbf{v}^{-1}, (\mathbf{S}/\mathbf{S}') \cup \mathbf{g}} \\ &= \partial^+ \theta_{\mathbf{v}^{-1}, \mathbf{S}/\mathbf{S}'} \end{aligned}$$

And since $\phi \circ \phi = I$, we also have that $\phi(\partial^+ \theta_{\mathbf{v}^{-1}, \mathbf{S}/\mathbf{S}'})$. Thus, $H^{\otimes n} \circ \phi$ sends Z -stabilizers to X -stabilizers and vice versa, thereby preserving the code space. Combining this with the above, $H^{\otimes n} \circ \phi$ realizes the logical form H_ϕ in the $(d, d/2)$ -Toric code. $\square$

Corollary 1.5. For the $(d, d/2)$ -Toric code, consider the gate $CZ_{S' \rightarrow S/S'} : L^{\otimes 2} \rightarrow L^{\otimes 2}$, defined to act on two encoded registers by applying $Z_{S/S'}$ on the second register, controlled by whether the logical $X_{S'}$ is turned on in the first register. Then $CZ_{S' \rightarrow S/S'}$ has a fold-transversal realization.

Proof. Consider the following circuit,

1. Apply H^n on the second register.
2. For any bit $\theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'}$, apply CX from $\theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'}$ in the first register into $\phi(\theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'})$ in the second register.

3. Again apply H^n on the second register.

□

Definition 1.6 (The φ Rotation). Consider a permutation from the generator set to itself $\pi: S \rightarrow S$. The permutation π induces a natural isomorphism by substituting generators of the product representation with their corresponding images according to π . We define the φ_π rotation, $\varphi_\pi: \mathcal{F}^{d'} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}^{d'}$, to act on the d' -dimensional faces as follows:

$$\varphi_\pi(\theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'}) := \theta_{\pi(\mathbf{v}), \pi(\mathbf{S}')}$$

Claim 1.7. Fix a permutation $\pi: S \rightarrow S$. Then φ_π satisfies the following:

1. φ_π sends the binary representation of X -stabilizers to themselves, and similarly for the binary representations of the Z -stabilizers.
2. For any generator subset $S' \subset S$, of size d' , the map φ_π sends $x_{S'}$ and $z_{S'}$ to $x_{\pi(S')}$ and $z_{\pi(S')}$ respectively.

Proof. For the first part of the claim, consider an arbitrary subset of generators $S' \subset S$ of size $d' + 1$, and notice that for any generator $g \in S'$, we have $\varphi_\pi(S'/g) = \varphi_\pi(S')/\varphi_\pi(g)$. Thus:

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi_\pi(\partial^- \theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'}) &= \varphi_\pi \left(\sum_{g \in S'} \theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'/g} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'/g} \right) \\ &= \sum_{g \in S'} \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}'/g)} + \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{g})\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}'/g)} \\ &= \sum_{g \in \varphi_\pi(S')} \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}')/g} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}')/g} \\ &= \partial^- \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}')} \end{aligned}$$

Similarly, we find that for any subset of generators $S' \subset S$ of size $d' - 1$:

$$\begin{aligned} \varphi_\pi(\partial^+ \theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}'}) &= \varphi_\pi \left(\sum_{g \in S/S'} \theta_{\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}' \cup g} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}^{-1}\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{S}' \cup g} \right) \\ &= \sum_{g \in S'} \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}' \cup g)} + \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{g}^{-1})\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}' \cup g)} \\ &= \sum_{g \in S/\varphi_\pi(S')} \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}') \cup g} + \theta_{\mathbf{g}^{-1}\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}') \cup g} \\ &= \partial^+ \theta_{\varphi_\pi(\mathbf{v}), \varphi_\pi(\mathbf{S}')} \end{aligned}$$

So, we have that φ_π sends binary representations of stabilizers to representations of stabilizers of the same type. For the second part, observe that under the automorphism

induced by π , the subgroup $\langle S' \rangle$ maps to $\langle \pi(S') \rangle$, Therefore:

$$\begin{aligned}\varphi_\pi(x_S) &= \varphi_\pi\left(\sum_{u \in \langle S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'}\right) = \sum_{u \in \langle \pi(S') \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, \pi(S')} = x_{\pi(S')} \\ \varphi_\pi(z_S) &= \varphi_\pi\left(\sum_{u \in \langle S/S' \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, S'}\right) = \sum_{u \in \langle S/\pi(S') \rangle} \theta_{\mathbf{u}, \pi(S')} = z_{\pi(S')}\end{aligned}$$

□

Corollary 1.8. For a $d' = d - d'$ and a fixed generator set $S' \subset S$, at size d' , consider the logical $H < ++ >$

Definition 1.9 (The Nice Encoding). Consider $(d, d/2)$ -Toric code and fix a subset $S' \subset S$, at size d' . We define the *nice encoding* to be the subsystem code, which uses $x_{S'}$ to encode a single logical qubit. Namely, the logical codewords are:

$$\begin{aligned}|\bar{0}\rangle &= |\mathcal{C}_Z^\perp\rangle \\ |\bar{1}\rangle &= |x_{S'} + \mathcal{C}_Z^\perp\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Claim 1.10. The nice encoding, admit fold-transversal realization of X , CX and CZ . Moreover, given a resource state, the nice encoding has a fold-transversal realization of the logical $\mathbf{S}$ gate.

Proof. We realize the gates as follow:

1. The logical X gate is implemented by applying the physical X operator over any non-trivial coordinate of $x_{S'}$.
2. The CX gate is realized by applying physical CX pair-wise.
3. For the CZ gate, consider the permutation $\pi : S \rightarrow S$, such that it maps the generators in S' to its complement, namely $\pi(S') = S/S'$. We first swap the qubits in the first register according to φ_π , then apply $CZ_{S' \rightarrow S/S'}$, and eventually invert the permutation on the first register.

Since, by Claim 1.7, φ_π acts trivially on stabilizers and sends $X_{S'}$ to $X_{S/S'}$, we get that the second step $CZ_{S' \rightarrow S/S'}$ conditions $Z_{S'}$ application on whether the first register initially contained $X_{S'} |\bar{0}\rangle = |\bar{1}\rangle$. The final inversion doesn't impact the second register.

4. For the $\mathbf{S}$ gate, we use the gate teleportation implementation, which uses logical CX , logical CZ , and the logical resource state $|\mathbf{S}\rangle$ defined by:

$$|\mathbf{S}\rangle := \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} (|\bar{0}\rangle + i|\bar{1}\rangle)$$

Figure 1 gives a description of the logical gate teleportation protocol.

□

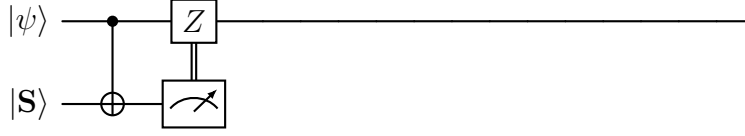


Figure 1: Simulating the **S**-gate, using the $|\mathbf{S}\rangle$ resource state.

2 Toric Encoded Circuits

Definition 2.1 (Troic Encoded Circuit). Let C be a quantum circuit. We say that C is *Toric encoded* if the following holds:

1. There is a Toric code $\mathcal{C}$ such that the qubits of $\mathcal{C}$ can be partitioned into registers $R_1, \dots, R_k$, and each of the registers is encoded by $\mathcal{C}$.
2. The gates in C with even time coordinates are sweep decoding gates.

For a set of faults $\mathcal{E}$ the gates in $C[\mathcal{E}]$ can be decomposed to cycles, of the following form:

$$C = D_l P_l \Lambda_l, \dots, D_1 P_1 \Lambda_1$$

Definition 2.2 (Base graph G_o). Let C be a quantum circuit, at depth d , with registers $R_1, \dots, R_k$, all of which are encoded by Toric codes with the same parameters (i.e., dimension, length, etc.). Let's denote by $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$ the Toric complexes that induce the codes. We define the base graph of C , denoted by $G_o = (V_o, E_o)$ as follows:

1. The vertices V_o are tuples, where the first coordinates correspond to a vertex in the union over the vertices in $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$, and the second coordinate is associated with a time. Namely:

$$V_o := \bigsqcup_i V(\mathcal{G}_i) \times [d]$$

2. The edges E_o are derived from the original edges in $\mathcal{G}_1, \dots, \mathcal{G}_k$, with the addition that any two vertices in preceding times t and $t + 1$ that support qubits (faces) such that C acts non-trivially on those qubits at time t are also connected by an edge. Namely:

$$E_o := \left\{ \{(v, t), (u, t')\} : \begin{array}{l} \text{either there exists } i \text{ such } \{v, u\} \in \mathcal{G}_i \text{ and } t' = t, t + 1 \\ \text{or there exists } u_i = (g_i, l_i) \in C \text{ such } v, u \in l_{i,2} \text{ and } t = l_{i,1}, t' = l_{i,1} + 1 \end{array} \right\}$$

[COMMENT] Here we should add that a vertex v belongs to location l if there is a qubit f that v belongs to its associated face.

Definition 2.3 (Time Graph of $C(\mathcal{E})$). For a quantum circuit C and set of faults $\mathcal{E}$, let us denote the base graph of $C[\mathcal{E}]$ by G_o . For each time t , denote the deviation induced by $\mathcal{E}$ at time t by $\mathcal{D}_t$, so $\partial\mathcal{D}_t$ is the syndrome that the qubits in the deviation admit. We define the history graph $\mathcal{H} = (V_{\mathcal{H}}, E_{\mathcal{H}})$ as follows:

1. The vertices $V_{\mathcal{H}}$ are taken to be the vertices of G_o , namely tuples $(v, t) \in V_o$, that satisfy that v belongs to a face associated with a check, which, at time t , belongs to the $\partial\mathcal{D}_t$. Namely:

$$\{v_t : v_t = (v, t) \in V_o \text{ and there exists a check } f \in C \text{ such } v \in f \in \partial\mathcal{D}_t\}$$

2. The edges $E_{\mathcal{H}}$ is partitioned into two types $A_{\mathcal{H}}$ and $F_{\mathcal{H}}$, where $A_{\mathcal{H}}$ are the edges in E_o restricted to $V_{\mathcal{H}}$ and $F_{\mathcal{H}}$ are defined to be the . Namely:

$$A_{\mathcal{H}} = \{e = \{u, v\} \in E_o : u, v \in V_{\mathcal{H}} \text{ and } T(v) = T(u) \pm 1\}$$

$$F_{\mathcal{H}} = \{e = \{u, v\} \in E_o : \text{exists } w \in V_{\mathcal{H}} \text{ such } \{v, w\}, \{u, w\} \in A_{\mathcal{H}}\}$$

By definition of the construction, $G_{\mathcal{H}}$ is a time-graph.

Definition 2.4 (**Size**(-)-Function). Let S be a subset of vertices, we define the *size* of S to be:

$$\mathbf{Size}(S) := \sum_i^{d+1} \max_{v \in S} L_i(v)$$

Claim 2.5. Let $\mathbf{S} = \{S_1, S_2, \dots, S_k\}$ where $S_i \subset \mathbb{R}^d$, introduce an edge between S_i and S_j iff $S_i \cap S_j \neq \emptyset$. Assume that $\mathbf{S}$ is connected. Then $\mathbf{Size}(\cup_{i=1}^k S_i) \leq \sum_{i=1}^k \mathbf{Size}(S_i)$.

Proof. It suffices to prove that if $R_1 \cap R_2 \neq \emptyset$, then $\mathbf{Size}(R_1 \cup R_2) \leq \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2)$. Let $a_{i,j} = \max_{v \in R_j} L_i(v)$. Then for any $w \in R_1 \cap R_2$ we have:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Size}(R_1 \cup R_2) &= \sum_i^{d+1} \max a_{i,1}, a_{i,2} = \sum_i^{d+1} a_{i,1} + a_{i,2} - \min a_{i,1}, a_{i,2} \\ &\leq \sum_i^{d+1} a_{i,1} + a_{i,2} - L_i(w) = \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2) - \mathbf{Size}(w) \\ &= \mathbf{Size}(R_1) + \mathbf{Size}(R_2) \end{aligned}$$

□

Definition 2.6 (Size Invariant Action). [\[COMMENT\] Here we classify both transversal gates, and rotation on the Toric.](#) An action g is be said size invariant action if, for any assignment z , it holds that $\mathbf{Size}(gz) = \mathbf{Size}(z)$.

Claim 2.7. The sweep rule is Size ξ -shrinking.

Proof.

□

[\[COMMENT\]](#) Eventually, we might not used the projected graph, and then we will split to history of the slices lemma for 3 parts. The first is when time = $3t$, in that we apply an invariant action so.